LEAN Data Governance DRAFT

[brackets] to fill in

PURPOSE

Correct, consistent master data: owned by the business, enforced by technology, with AI agents doing the routine work.

SCOPE

Four domains, one per GPDO (global process and data owner): Commercial, Manufacturing, Finance and Procurement.

SAP master data: governed in full.

Non-SAP and confidential data: owned and protected now.

THE PROBLEM

Incorrect: wrong or missing values break transactions and reports.

Inconsistent: duplicates, clashing conventions, systems that disagree.

Risks: trade secrets, payment fraud, privacy and audit.

GUIDING POLICY

Technology runs governance; people decide.

Lightweight policies, **E**mbedded controls, **A**gent-operated work and **N**amed ownership.

The app decides by default; people decide only what needs judgement or a fraud check.

THE TARGET SETUP

1. Own. GPDOs delegate parts to attribute owners, who set the checks and what the app may approve.

2. Enforce. The app approves what owners allow. Owners approve the rest, prepared by agents.

3. Run and assure. The data team runs it; internal controls reviews changes made without a request.

22 RULES

- Each says what must be true, and why
- 12 fix incorrect and inconsistent data
- 10 manage trade secret, fraud, privacy and audit risk
- 5 of them apply everywhere from the start

NEVER SWITCHED OFF

- Someone else confirms sensitive changes
- Nobody approves their own request or exception
- Payment data kept apart from paying
- Bank details verified with the supplier
- Agents never approve, confirm or delete
- Trade secrets stay in AI the organisation controls
- Every change traces to an approved request

MEASURES

- Share of requests the app approves alone
- People’s decisions, and how long they take
- Records passing their checks
- Duplicates and system differences
- Changes without a request

Targets: [to set]

Who owns and decides DRAFT

[brackets] to fill in

PRINCIPLE

Every piece of data has one named owner. A routine change needs one person, the requester; a sensitive change, such as to bank details, needs two.

WHO APPROVES WHAT

Charter: the four GPDOs and the platform owner

Rulebook, operating model, controls: the platform owner, after the owner review if they add work

Domain profiles: the GPDO the breakdown, attribute owners their part's settings

DATA OWNER: THE GPDO

- Accountable for the whole domain, in every system
- Approves the breakdown and who owns each part
- Sets the conventions across the domain
- Agrees shared data with the other GPDO
- Decides what's escalated to them

ATTRIBUTE OWNER

- Owns one part: a subdomain, business unit or group of fields
- Sets its checks, sensitive fields and other settings in the app
- Approves its exceptions and mass changes
- Decides who sees its classified data
- Decides what the app can't, or names delegates

DELEGATES

- Optional: two or more, shared across parts
- Confirm sensitive changes
- Decide likely duplicates
- Approve what the app can't, and review a monthly sample

Never settings, exceptions, mass changes or access. Payment confirmers can't buy, pay or release credit.

PLATFORM OWNER

Held by the Head of Data, AI & Development [name]

- Accountable for the app, data platform, agents and data team
- Approves the rulebook, operating model and controls
- Decides nothing about data content

DATA TEAM

The platform owner's team

- Builds and runs the app, platform and agents
- Owns and supervises the agents
- Runs the owner review; keeps the documents current
- Provides the template, starters and training

INTERNAL CONTROLS

Held by the internal controls team [name]

- Reviews emergency access
- Reviews changes made without a request
- Samples the change reconciler agent's matches

The rules on one page DRAFT

[brackets] to fill in

HOW THE RULES WORK

22 short rules in seven groups say what must be true; the controls say how. Each domain sets what good data looks like in its profile.

APPLY EVERYWHERE

Five rules cover all data from the start, SAP or not: **ownership**, **classified access**, **trade secrets** and **AI tools**. The rest cover SAP now, and other systems as they come in.

INCORRECT AND INCONSISTENT DATA

Ownership R-01, R-02	Every domain has a named owner, its GPDO, and every field on every record exactly one owner.
Changing master data R-03 to R-08	Changes only through the governed process, with one system of record for each field. Requests are checked, then approved by the app as owners allow, or by an owner; mass changes need sign-off; every change traces to an approved request.
Quality and third parties R-09 to R-12	Each domain sets its conventions, checks and thresholds. Issues are fixed at source, unused records are blocked, and third parties work within the rules.

TRADE SECRET, FRAUD, PRIVACY AND AUDIT RISK

Sensitive and payment data R-13 to R-15	Changes to sensitive fields, such as bank details, need someone else to confirm them. Payment data is kept apart from paying, and bank changes are verified with the supplier.
Trade secrets, privacy and access R-16, R-17, R-21	Classified fields, with access only where needed. Trade secrets get the highest classification everywhere. Personal data is blocked when its purpose ends, then deleted.
Agents and AI R-18, R-22	Agents are registered, limited and logged. AI never takes instructions from outside content; outside models need approval and never get trade secrets.
Data team and exceptions R-19, R-20	The data team uses the governed process too. Exceptions are approved by the owner and time-limited.

Operating model: who does what DRAFT

[brackets] to fill in

IN SHORT

GPDOs set up the domain. Attribute owners set their parts and decide the daily cases, or hand them to delegates. The data team runs the platform.

RHYTHM

- Decisions happen in the app, not in meetings
- Agents prompt owners and chase what's overdue
- Owner review: monthly at first, then quarterly
- Quarterly scorecard to the executive team

Activity	Covers	GPDO	Attribute owner	Data team	Platform owner	How often
Set up the domain	Breakdown, owners, conventions, shared data	A/R	C	C	I	On change
Set each part's settings	Checks, automatic approvals, exceptions, mass changes	I	A/R	C	–	As needed
Control access	Who sees classified data; access reviews; extracts	–	A/R	R	–	[Twice a year]
Decide daily cases	Sensitive changes, duplicates, what the app can't; samples	–	A/R	–	–	Daily
Build and run the platform	App, data platform and agents; agent supervision	I	I	R	A	Ongoing
Keep the framework current	Rulebook, operating model and controls catalogue	C	C	R	A	On change

R responsible · **A** accountable · **C** consulted · **I** informed. The GPDO stays accountable for the whole domain; A is who answers for each decision. Shaded: an attribute owner can hand this to delegates. Agents do much of the work but are never accountable.

MEASURES

Targets: [to set] after a month's baseline

- Requests the app approves alone
- People's decisions, and how long they take
- Time from request to use; first-time-right
- Records passing their checks
- Duplicates; SAP and non-SAP differences
- Downstream issues traced to master data
- Changes without an approved request
- Agents: work, acceptance and review time

Operating model: platform and agents DRAFT

[brackets] to fill in

THE SPLIT

A check with a fixed answer belongs in the app. Coordination and routine work go to agents. Decisions stay with people.

AGENT GUARDRAILS

- Never approve, confirm or grant access
- Never delete records or change sensitive fields
- Start by proposing; later, only routine changes owners allow
- A named owner in the data team; every action logged
- AI models approved by the platform owner
- Trade secrets stay in AI the organisation controls

UNIFIED MASTER DATA APP

- The front door for SAP master data
- Holds each domain's settings
- Checks every request on entry
- Approves the routine requests owners allow
- Routes the rest; holds sensitive changes
- Records the request behind each change

SAP

- The system of record
- Changed only by the app, or by a domain's own process, such as engineering change
- Change documents record every change

DATA PLATFORM

- Checks stored data and builds the scorecards
- Compares non-SAP copies with SAP
- Finds changes without a request
- Holds the data agents read

AI AGENTS

Request assistant
For requesters
Pre-fills requests, explains failed checks and flags values that look wrong.

Owner assistant
For owners and delegates
Prepares each case and its evidence, and chases what's overdue.

Quality agent
For attribute owners
Finds duplicates and their causes, raises fixes and cleans up existing data.

Governance coordinator
For GPDOs and the platform owner
Prepares the owner review and scorecard; tracks decisions and exceptions.

Change reconciler
For internal controls
Matches SAP changes to the requests behind them, and reports any without.